approach to culture is characteristic of coloniality which decoloniality seeks to counter.[21] Simply stated, a North American-style ethnocentric blood quantum-based approach to issues of culture, consciousness and indigeneity have been largely steered clear of by the decolonial school since it uses OET of a society as its primary marker. This is in contradistinction to coloniality's embedded Christian-inspired race consciousness, which is projected on to every indigenous movement, whether or not ethnic consciousness is material to it. Therefore, decoloniality's attempts at de-racialisation of indigeneity to the extent permitted by indigenous worldviews pre-empts labels, such as ethnonationalism and xenophobia, which are often used to undermine the legitimacy of indigenous movements.

It is important to clarify that decoloniality does not turn a blind eye to issues of ethnicity, including historic realities, where ethnicity has formed the basis of discrimination by the coloniser. However, its prism of enquiry is largely, if not exclusively, based on the 'culture is a way of life' approach which recognises that a culture or a civilisation is the product of several influences. Further, decoloniality seeks to rid both 'culture' and 'civilisation' of its colonial code, an exercise integral to the freeing of indigenous societies from the burden of having to demonstrate their cultured and civilised status on Western-normative benchmarks.

One of the reasons ethnicity is perhaps but one of the components of a decolonial approach, as opposed to being the sole, is the recognition that an exclusively ethnocentric approach can be a slippery slope, given the constant migration or invasion or intermingling of peoples in history. It is for this reason that decoloniality pays more attention to the relationship between an OET framework which informs consciousness, and a culture or a civilisation. The corollary to and consequence of this OET-based approach to consciousness is that it accommodates and is alive to the fact that just as there are colonialised natives who subscribe to the European worldview despite not sharing the race of the coloniser, so are there decolonialised non-natives who are committed to protecting indigenous OETs despite not sharing the native ethnicity. After all, if coloniality is a state of mind that cuts across ethnicities, so should decoloniality, which too is a state of mind.

At this juncture, it is also important to address another aspect of indigenous societies, namely hereditary social structures, which have been